



The Monday Morning Workflow Template

AI That Actually Works: Live Demos HR Can Use Monday Morning

Use this once, this week, on one real task you would otherwise do by hand. Everything on stage ran four moves: **capture** a record, **connect** it to your real work, **structure** it in a project, then **direct** it. These two pages are the direct step.

THE FIVE STEPS · STEPS 1 TO 3

1 Name the experts

More than one. You are assembling a team, not searching. **Never leave this blank.**

Start with: "You are an expert in _____, _____, and _____."

2 Introduce yourself, or the context

Your role, the organization, its size, the policy environment. Whatever a new hire would need on day one.

Start with: "I am the _____ at _____. We have about _____ employees, and _____."

3 State the issue. The what and the why, not the how

The moment you dictate the method, you constrain it to the one approach you already had. **Let it propose the how.**

Start with: "The situation is _____. This matters because _____."

4 Outline the big goal

What does finished look like. Most people aim far too small here and get exactly what they asked for.

Start with: "When this is done well, _____."

5 Give the command

Name the artifact you want in your hands. A memo, a table, a packet, a script, a checklist.

Start with: "Give me _____. Ask me any clarifying questions first."

Say it, do not type it. Windows key + H on Windows. Dictation on Mac. The microphone icon in any app. Spoken, these five steps take about forty seconds. Typed, most people quit halfway and send something thin.

AFTER THE FIRST ANSWER · FOUR MOVES, IN ORDER

1. Answer its questions

It will ask for clarification. That exchange is where the quality actually comes from. Do not skip it.

2. Re-run it in thinking mode

Same prompt, extended reasoning on. Better output, and you get to watch how it structured the work.

3. "Grade this out of ten."

It will often say six or seven and tell you exactly what is weak. Believe it.

4. "Now give me the ten."

Two sentences of your time. A bigger improvement than an hour of your own editing.

Then the follow-up that turns one answer into usable work: **"Now build a separate packet for each party, including the opening script."**

One worked example, start to finish

HR documentation. The task nearly everyone in the room did by hand this month. Names below are fictional. Note carefully what is deliberately **not** in the prompt.

THE SITUATION

An employee reports that his manager called him out publicly on a team call in a way he believes was connected to a medical restriction he has not disclosed to that manager. He wants it looked into. You need to run a clean process and you need it documented properly.

WHAT YOU SAY OUT LOUD

[1 Experts] You are an expert in HR investigations, employment law, and workplace documentation. You are acting as my HR business partner.

[2 Context] I am the HR manager at a mid-sized company with about four hundred employees across three states. We have a written code of conduct, an anti-harassment policy, and state addenda in our handbook.

[3 Issue] An employee has reported that his manager singled him out publicly on a video call in a way he believes relates to a medical restriction he has not disclosed to that manager. He believes it violates our code of conduct. This matters because if we handle the process badly we compound the original harm and we create exposure.

[4 Goal] When this is done well, I know which policies may have been implicated, I have run a fair and consistent process, and I have a clear path to resolution with both people.

[5 Command] Give me an investigation toolkit: the questions to ask each party, a neutral documentation structure, and the process steps in order. Ask me any clarifying questions first.

WHAT IS DELIBERATELY MISSING, AND WHY

No names. No diagnosis. No employee ID. No department. The model does not need any of it to build the toolkit. Describe the **restriction or the behavior**, never the condition. You add the identifying detail yourself, inside your own system of record, after the structure comes back.

What to use, what it costs, what is safe

Observed August 2026. These prices and terms move constantly. Confirm the current data-handling language in writing before you buy, and before you put anything real into it.

TIER	ROUGHLY	WHAT YOU GET	EMPLOYEE DATA?
Free ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot	\$0	Genuinely capable. Enough to learn and practice every technique from this session.	NO Inputs may be used to improve the product. Treat it as public.
Individual paid	About \$20 per user, monthly	Higher limits, stronger models, better file handling. Worth it once you use it daily.	NO Still a personal account with no agreement covering your employer.
Business or Team ChatGPT Business, Claude Team	About \$20 to \$30 per user, monthly	Admin controls, retention settings, audit trail.	YES Inputs excluded from model training by default. Verify for your plan.
Microsoft 365 Copilot inside your tenant	About \$21 per user, monthly, add-on	Runs inside the environment your organization already governs. Often the fastest approval path.	YES Inherits your existing permissions and retention rules.

Two questions for IT this week. Do we already have Microsoft 365 Copilot, and is it enabled on my license? And what is our approved AI tool list, and who signs off on adding one? In most HR departments the blocker is approval, not budget.

FOUR RULES FOR BUYING ANY AI TOOL

1. Free version first, every time

Prove you will actually use it for two weeks before a card comes out.

2. Monthly, never annual

These tools change faster than the contract. Something better ships during your term.

3. A 25-day calendar reminder

Review before it renews, not after. Worth more than any single tool.

4. One tool at a time

Adoption fails on stacks, not on tools. Get one workflow working first.

The guardrails

General guidance for HR practice. This is not legal advice. Run your AI policy past your own employment counsel before you adopt it.

NEVER PUT THESE IN A CONSUMER ACCOUNT

- **Names attached to a complaint or investigation.** The accused, the reporter, and every witness.
- **Medical or disability information.** Anything ADA adjacent, accommodation files, leave certifications.
- **Discipline and performance documentation** tied to an identifiable person.
- **Compensation data, social security numbers, immigration documents.**
- **Anything that could be produced under subpoena.** If it can be discovered, it can be read back to you.

If you would not email it to a vendor you have no agreement with, **do not paste it into a model you have no agreement with.**

BEFORE YOU RELY ON ANY OUTPUT

Never let AI make the determination

It drafts, summarizes, and organizes. You decide. In our function that distinction is the entire ballgame.

Check every citation against the source document

Your actual handbook, the actual statute, the actual policy. The model will state a citation cleanly and confidently and sometimes invent it. If you cannot point to the source, it does not go in the file.

Record that a human reviewed it

One line in the file. You will be glad it is there the day somebody asks how the document was produced.

Know your retention setting before you need to know it

Chat history is a record. Find out today what your tool keeps and for how long.

Your assignment

Learning objective 3. This is the part that turns an hour in a conference room into a change in how you work.

ONE TASK · ONE WORKFLOW · BEFORE NEXT FRIDAY

One workflow, on one real task.

One workflow, applied one time, on something that was genuinely on your desk. That is the objective. Work down the list and date it at the bottom.

- ☐ I picked one task I did by hand this month and dreaded.
- ☐ I confirmed which tool I am allowed to use for it.
- ☐ I spoke all five steps instead of typing them.
- ☐ I answered its clarifying questions before judging the output.
- ☐ I asked it to grade the output, then asked for the ten.
- ☐ I verified every citation against the source document.
- ☐ I used the result on the real task, not a practice version.

Date I will have this done: _____

NOTES

I talk fast. Catch the one thing you want to try first, and write it here before you leave the room.



Everything from this session

This template, the prompt scaffold, and the free community.
No form wall on the template itself.

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